

# Business Intelligence Overview Report

## 1. What is Business Intelligence?

Business Intelligence (BI) is the use of data, analytical processes and reporting tools to transform raw business information into meaningful information that supports decision-making. In a business environment, BI helps organisations collect, prepare, analyse and present information in a form that managers and other decision-makers can understand and use. A BI solution can bring together information from business datasets and present performance measures, trends and comparisons through reports and interactive dashboards.

## 2. Why Organisations Use Dashboards

Organisations use dashboards to provide a clear and consolidated view of important business performance measures. Instead of requiring managers to examine large amounts of raw data, a dashboard presents key performance indicators (KPIs) and visualisations in one place. Interactive features such as slicers and filters allow users to examine performance from different perspectives, including categories, regions, products and customer segments.

For the retail business scenario in this assignment, the dashboard is intended to help management monitor sales performance, profitability, customer behaviour and regional performance. The assignment requires the dashboard to include meaningful KPIs and appropriate visualisations so that management can monitor performance and identify important patterns.

## 3. How Dashboards Improve Decision-Making

Dashboards improve decision-making by making business information easier to interpret and compare. Visualisations can reveal trends, differences between regions or categories, and areas of stronger or weaker performance more quickly than raw tables alone. Interactive reports also allow decision-makers to focus on specific parts of the business and investigate performance from different dimensions.

In this Week 2 project, the Power BI dashboard brings together KPI cards, charts, a matrix and slicers. These elements allow management to review sales, profit, orders, average sales and profit margin while also analysing product, category, regional, segment and time-based performance.

## 4. Business Objective of the Selected Dataset

The business objective of the selected retail dataset is to support analysis of sales and profitability performance and provide information that can help management make better strategic decisions. The Week 2 assignment identifies seven business questions for the dashboard: overall sales performance; regions generating the highest sales and profit; customer segments contributing the most revenue; best-performing product categories; most profitable products; trends over time; and recommendations for improving business performance.

The resulting Power BI dashboard addresses these objectives by presenting sales and profit measures across categories, sub-categories, products, regions and customer segments, together with a monthly sales trend and interactive filters. This provides a practical BI view of the retail business and creates a foundation for evidence-based recommendations.

## 5. Conclusion

Business Intelligence and dashboards support organisations by turning business data into accessible performance information. For the retail case in this assignment, the Power BI dashboard provides management with an interactive way to monitor key performance measures, compare business areas and identify trends. The analysis can therefore support more informed decisions about sales, profitability, products, categories, regions and customer segments.